



ALLOCATION & AFFILIATION POLICIES

Update

Regular Park Board Meeting
Tuesday, March 31, 2026



- Share draft affiliation criteria, allocation principles, and allocation prioritization.
- Describe how engagement with user groups will inform and guide the development of completed policies.



- *Affiliation* prioritizes access to facilities for groups based on public benefit, inclusion, safety, and equity.
- *Allocation* decides how a limited number of spaces are strategically, consistently, and equitably distributed among user groups.
 - To implement permitting changes in 2027, these policies need to be completed by July 2026.

- Historically, space was carried over for those who were there first. Without policy guidelines, inequities and inefficiencies developed.
- Municipalities are shifting from historic allocation to prioritize community, equity, safety, and alignment with sport standards.
- The Board approved Comprehensive Fee-setting Framework connects taxpayer investment to services that provide greatest public benefit.
- Staff developed a framework of allocation best practices in collaboration with several western Canadian municipalities.

- Affiliation and Allocation Policies will improve experiences for user groups accessing pools, arenas, and outdoor sport facilities.
 - Established groups will find efficiencies in a clear, consistent, and transparent process for booking a limited number of facilities.
 - Emerging and equity deserving groups will see improved access to spaces to grow their sports communities.
 - Swimmers, divers, hockey players, figure skaters, soccer, rugby, baseball, softball players, and many more, will benefit from opportunities to play provided through policy guidance.

- Recreation facilities are subsidized by taxpayer investment, with the full costs of Capital and Operating higher than most fees charged.
- Affiliation and allocation prioritization connects access to these facilities to the relative benefit provided to everyone in Vancouver.
- For e.g., prioritizing youth sports promotes lifelong healthy living habits and physical literacy that benefits everyone:
 - Decreased future health care costs;
 - Reduced reliance on emergency services; and,
 - Increased social well-being.

- Staff reviewed historic practices, researched precedents, and built on established frameworks.
- Engagement with user groups shaped the direction and will be essential moving forward:
 - A survey was completed in 2025 to understand challenges, with responses from nearly 125 organizations.
 - A launch workshop was held in December 2025 with all user groups invited (75 participated).
 - In early 2026, engagement with user groups by service line confirmed the criteria and principles shared in this update.

- 70%+ participants are **residents**.
- Registered **non-profit**.
- **In good standing** with governing body and the Park Board.
- Committed to **SafeSport**.
- Provides mechanism that **allows users facing financial barriers to participate**.



Allocation Principles

- Prioritize public good.
- Equitable, inclusive, and safe.
- Emphasize clarity.
- Establish consistency across service lines.
- Balance activity needs, events, and community.
- Ensure practical, adaptable, and effective delivery.
- Gather data and accommodate feedback.

Prioritization

1. Park Board programs
2. Park Board sponsored
3. Affiliated minor
4. Affiliated adult
5. Non-profit minor
6. Non-profit adult
7. Commercial recreation
8. Commercial

- Ahead of the Vancouver Aquatic Centre closure, an interim affiliation and allocation approach is being developed.
- Staff engaged groups in February 2026 and will return to discuss allocation after completing pool capacity analysis.
- This interim aquatics approach is aligned with larger policy development but advancing first due to necessity – it will inform and then be replaced by full policies later, if approved by the Board.

Potential Impact	Mitigation
A user group may not meet affiliation criteria.	Non-affiliated groups are still allocated space, just after the prioritized affiliated groups.
A user group may lose space or time they were previously allocated.	Changes to allocation should be capped and/or phased over time. Greater efficiency in the system may offset losses.
The outcomes are unknown and felt differently among user groups.	Engagement will bring individual groups together to workshop options and identify benefits for the larger community.

- A series of connected projects depend on completion of Affiliation and Allocation Policies:
 - Approved policies are necessary to implement software changes.
 - Improvements to user fee policies are also underway.
 - The combination of updated policies allows for enhanced user experience and increased equity in permitting for 2027.
- A lack of policy leads to user group needs not being met, increased inequities, and sets us back from regional and provincial direction.

- Affiliation and allocation improves access to recreation, benefitting all people and communities.
- Staff will consult Provincial Sport Organizations for standards, test formulas, and engage sport-specific user groups with allocation options.
- Completed policies will be brought back to the Board for decision in July 2026.



